

2.1.2.1 Questions and answers

We've said that the basis for any presentation should be the conveying of knowledge, and that everything else comes next. But bland facts are not easily absorbed. They aren't taken kindly to. They're also apt to induce sleep—and in extreme cases, deep, bear-like hibernation.

It seems on the surface that you can't pep things up. But you can.

It's just psychology: if something is imposed upon a person, he or she will be apt to reject it for the sole reason that it is being imposed. On the other hand, if there is a *question* in the person's mind, and you can provide an answer, that answer is absorbed.

The lesson? Figure what questions *your presentation* will answer; what questions *the audience* has that your presentation will answer. *Create* questions if you can. Base your show around all these questions. Then answer them.

Here's an example. A boring slide reads (let's keep it simple):

*Axis Is A Major Global Player In The Cell Phone Space
We Are Now Entering The Indian Market*

Now how do you rephrase this so that questions are answered? Take this one:

*Prepare To See Phones With Axis Inside™!
We've Seen The World. Now We're Here.*

Apart from the fact that this radically different version carries more punch (while carrying essentially the same information), it answers questions. The audience came into the room with the question, "Why is Axis giving a presentation, and what do I get?" The first line answers that. Then, the question arises: "Can I trust these new phones?" The second line answers that—yes, you can, because they've "seen the world," meaning they know what